



### Qualcomm handheld console

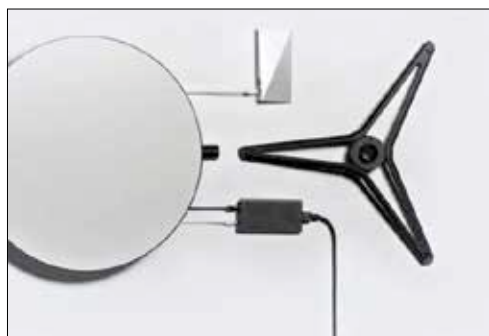
A report suggests that Qualcomm is building an Android powered Nintendo Switch clone. <http://dgit.in/apr21-03>



### Apple Music "saylists"

Apple Music has added a "saylists" feature to help people with speech-sound disorders navigate better. <http://dgit.in/apr21-04>

Source: Starlink website



The Starlink Kit

The first batch of Starlink satellites were launched into orbit in May 2019. The satellites are strapped onto the top of SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket and launched into orbit, with about 60 satellites being released per launch.

Satellite internet technology already exists and has done so for decades now. It works by beaming internet data via radio cables through the vacuum of space. Ground stations on Earth broadcast signals to the satellites and the internet satellites then relay the data back to customers on the planet. HughesNet is an example of a satellite internet service that leverages satellites 22,000 miles above our planet to provide internet access to its users. Where Starlink differentiates itself is that the company uses low-Earth orbiting satellites that are orbiting merely 300 miles above the surface of the planet. The drop in distance the signal needs to travel results in dramatically improved internet speeds and lower latency. In the testing phase, the latency of Starlink was between 20 ms and 40 ms. Additionally, the goal of having around 12,000 satellites means that the company can provide global coverage without too many service dropouts.

The service isn't inexpensive by any means though. The subscription to the beta service is currently priced at \$99 per month. Additionally, users also have to fork out another \$499 to get the Starlink Kit that includes a mounting tripod, a Wi-Fi router, and a terminal to connect to the satellites. In February, SpaceX began taking in preorders for the

service in countries other than the US. Users can put down a \$100 deposit that will be applied to the total amount to be paid once the service becomes available in their area. Starlink requires an unobstructed view of the sky, so users will have to download the Starlink app to ascertain the best location for the installation of Starlink. The company has

suggested that the Starlink satellite dish should be installed at the highest point of elevation possible to avoid any obstructions.

### STARLINK IN INDIA

A major benefit of satellite internet technology is that it can provide internet to people living even in the most remote or rural areas on the globe. It will alleviate the overt dependency on mobile internet that doesn't usually doesn't run at full capacity and provides slow internet speeds, allowing users to leverage high-speed internet. This is especially useful in a country like India where people living in rural areas do not have access to a fast broadband connection. These areas usually also have more open space and a clearer view of the sky, allowing Starlink to work at its full potential.

SpaceX reportedly aims to launch Starlink in India sometime in 2022. The company has listed numerous Indian locations where services will be available on a first-come-first-serve basis. Starlink is now available in India for preorders at \$99 (roughly ₹7200). Users can check the availability of the service in India by typing in their city and postal code. Once users click the 'Order Now' button, they will be redirected to a page where they will need to input their details such as name, phone number, email address,

etc. Users will, of course, have to pay a \$99 deposit as is the case in all the countries. However, the company has noted that this amount is refundable.

Satellite internet has tons of potential in a country like India since it will be able to tear down the barriers between urban and rural areas, allowing fast internet speeds for all. It can even provide coverage in areas where coverage through on-ground mobile towers is difficult. SpaceX will, no doubt, have its sights set on India since it is one of the fastest-growing markets in terms of internet adoption. As per the WEF, the number of internet users in India grew by 23 per cent between 2019 and 2020. However, the cost may be a huge barrier to adoption since people in India, especially those living in remote and rural areas may not have the means to fork out a hefty sum of money for the internet satellite service. It will be interesting to see whether SpaceX alters the price of its service according to the financial capability of a country, or area. In any case, Starlink does have some competition in India. Hughes India, a subsidiary of Hughes Network



Starlink to launch in India in 2022

Systems, recently tied up with ISRO, and used their GSAT-19 and GSAT-11 communications satellites, to provide internet connectivity to 5,000 remote villages in the Eastern part of India. Additionally, Bharti Airtel is also planning to launch a satellite internet service in India by 2022 leveraging OneWeb's internet satellites. 